Notice in *Figure 2.3* that you can have multiple workspaces assigned to the same metastore. **Access Controls** and **User Management** are scoped to the account level, as shown in the figure. A UC **Metastore**, a group of catalogs, is scoped to a region with precisely one metastore per region. Within the region, you can easily share **Data**, **Features**, **Volumes** access, **Functions**, and **Models**.

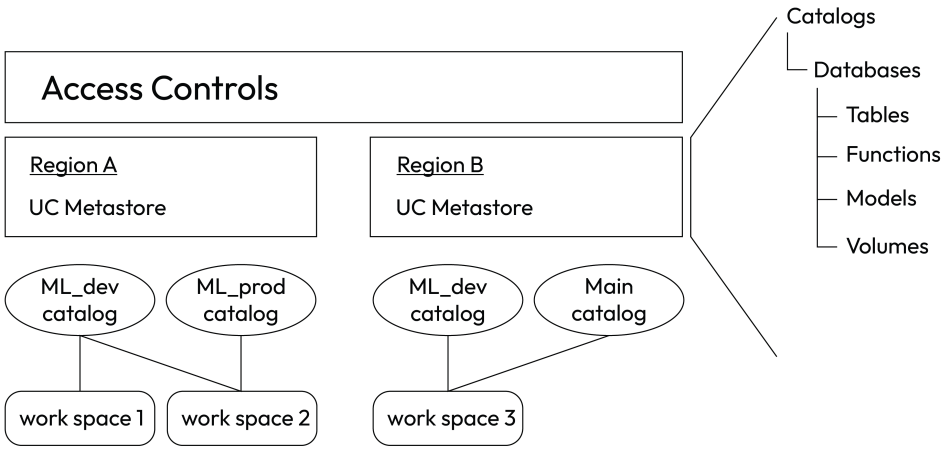


Figure 2.3 – The Design of Unity Catalog with multiple workspaces

Unity Catalog is more than a group of data assets. UC also tracks who has accessed assets, which makes auditing a simple exercise. Using UC allows companies to administer privileges and secure data and objects easily while being able to share them between various workspaces. Securely sharing between environments is one of the reasons why we recommend using the UC metastore.

The HMS design is less centralized than that of UC. For example, historically, workspaces have been created as data and code isolation, meaning there is a separate workspace for separate isolation levels. This design often required a centralized model registry workspace in addition to development, staging, and production workspaces. If not using UC, each workspace requires its own HMS and user and group management. In contrast, UC governs all assets at the account level rather than the individual workspace level; see *Figure 2.3*, *Figure 2.4*, and *Further reading*. The centralized governance model provides the ability to integrate multiple workspaces more seamlessly.